

166. Chapter 14 Verses 11-15

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 14.11

सर्वद्वारेषु देहे ऽस्मिन्प्रकाश उपजायते ।
ज्ञानं यदा तदा विद्याद्विवृद्धं सत्त्वमित्युत ॥ 11 ॥

sarva-dvāreṣhu dehe 'smin prakāśha upajāyate
jñānam yadā tadā vidyād vivṛiddham sattvam ity uta

sarva—all; dvāreṣhu—through the gates; dehe—body; asmin—in this; prakāśhaḥ—illumination; upajāyate—manifest; jñānam—knowledge; yadā—when; tadā—then; vidyāt—know; vivṛiddham—predominates; sattvam—mode of goodness; iti—thus; uta—certainly;

When the light of knowledge shines through all the gateways of the body, then it may be known that sattva has prevailed.

VERSE 14.12

लोभः प्रवृत्तिरारम्भः कर्मणामशमः स्पृहा ।
रजस्येतानि जायन्ते विवृद्धे भरतर्षभ ॥ 12 ॥

lobhaḥ pravṛittir ārambhaḥ karmaṇām aśhamāḥ spṛihā
rajasy etāni jāyante vivṛiddhe bharatarṣhabha

lobhaḥ—greed; **pravṛittiḥ**—activity; **ārambhaḥ**—exertion; **karmaṇām**—for
fruitive actions; **aśhamāḥ**—restlessness; **spṛihā**—craving; **rajasi**—of the mode
of passion; **etāni**—these; **jāyante**—develop; **vivṛiddhe**—when predominates;
bharata-ṛiṣhabha—the best of the Bharatas, Arjun;

**Greed, activity, enterprise, unrest, longing— these arise, O
lord of the Bhāratas, when rajas prevails.**

VERSE 14.13

aparakāśho 'pravṛittiś cha pramādo moha eva cha
tamasy etāni jāyante vivṛiddhe kuru-nandana

aparakāśhaḥ—nescience; apravṛittiḥ—inertia; cha—and; pramādaḥ—negligence; mohaḥ—delusion; eva—indeed; cha—also; tamasi—mode of ignorance; etāni—these; jāyante—manifest; vivṛiddhe—when dominates; kuru-nandana—the joy of the Kurus, Arjun

Darkness, indolence, inadvertence, delusion— all these arise, O descendant of Kuru, when tamas prevails.

VERSE 14.14

यदा सत्त्वे प्रवृद्धे तु प्रलयं याति देहभृत् ।
तदोत्तमविदां लोकानमलान्प्रतिपद्यते ॥ 14 ॥

yadā sattve pravṛiddhe tu pralayaṁ yāti deha-bhṛit
tadottama-vidāṁ lokān amalān pratipadyate

yadā—when; **sattve**—in the mode of goodness; **pravṛiddhe**—when premodinates; **tu**—indeed; **pralayaṁ**—death; **yāti**—reach; **deha-bhṛit**—the embodied; **tadā**—then; **uttama-vidāṁ**—of the learned; **lokān**—abodes; **amalān**—pure; **pratipadyate**—attains;

**If the embodied soul meets with death when sattva prevails,
it goes to the spotless realms of those who know the Highest.**

VERSE 14.15

रजसि प्रलयं गत्वा कर्मसङ्गिषु जायते ।
तथा प्रलीनस्तमसि मूढयोनिषु जायते ॥ 15 ॥

rajasi pralayaṁ gatvā karma-saṅgiṣhu jāyate
tathā pralīnas tamasi mūḍha-yoniṣhu jāyate

rajasi—in the mode of passion; **pralayam**—death; **gatvā**—attaining; **karma-saṅgiṣhu**—among people driven by work; **jāyate**—are born; **tathā**—likewise; **pralīnaḥ**—dying; **tamasi**—in the mode of ignorance; **mūḍha-yoniṣhu**—in the animal kingdom; **jāyate**—takes birth

If the embodied soul meets with death when rajas prevails, it is born among those who are attached to action; and if it meets with death when tamas prevails, it is born in the wombs of creatures devoid of reason.